Theme 5 title 2 child edition

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MORE THAN JUST A STORY
A Fun 30-Day Journey Through the Heroes of the Old Testament
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A Note for Parents

Have you ever read a story to your child and watched their eyes light up? Maybe it was a story about a brave hero. Maybe it was a story about a big adventure. Maybe it was a story about a talking animal. Their eyes got wide. Their mouth dropped open. They could not wait to hear what happened next. That is the power of a story.

The Old Testament is full of stories. It is full of heroes. It is full of adventures. Noah and the ark. Moses and the Red Sea. David and Goliath. Jonah and the big fish. These are not just old stories. These are not just history lessons. They are clues. They are treasures. They are adventures. And every single one of them points to Jesus.

This book is a 30 day adventure for you and your kids. We are going to read the stories. We are going to find the clues. We are going to discover the treasure. You do not need to be a Bible expert to lead this. You just need to be willing to explore with your kids. Get ready to put on your adventure hats. Get ready to open the book. Get ready to find Jesus.

How to Use This Book

This is a 30 day journey. Each day takes about 5 to 10 minutes. Read the secret clue. Read the big reveal. Do the family activity together. Say the prayer out loud. Let your child color the picture. The goal is not perfection. The goal is connection. Have fun with it. Get messy. Ask questions. Laugh together. This is an adventure. Let us begin.

Day 01: The Story of the Hero of Faith

The Secret Clue (OT)
"By faith Abraham, when called to go to a place he would later receive as his inheritance, obeyed and went, even though he did not know where he was going." - Hebrews 11:8

Abraham was a hero. He had big faith. God told him to leave his home. God told him to go to a new land. Abraham did not know where he was going. But he trusted God. He obeyed. He went. He was a hero of faith. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For you know the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, that though he was rich, yet for your sake he became poor, so that you through his poverty might become rich." - 2 Corinthians 8:9

Jesus is the greater hero. Abraham left his home. Jesus left heaven. Abraham went to a land he did not know. Jesus came to a world he created. Abraham trusted God. Jesus trusted the Father. Abraham was a hero of faith. Jesus is the ultimate hero of faith.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a big adventure. A path. A mountain. A treasure. Write the name "Jesus" at the end of the path. Talk about how Abraham followed God, and how Jesus is the treasure at the end of the trail.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the ultimate hero. Thank you for leaving heaven for me. Help me to trust you. Help me to follow you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A person walking on a path with a big smile and a bright light ahead.

Day 02: The Story of the Hero of Sacrifice

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Then God said, 'Take your son, your only son, whom you love—Isaac—and go to the region of Moriah. Sacrifice him there as a burnt offering on a mountain I will show you.'" - Genesis 22:2

Abraham was a hero. God tested him. God asked him to sacrifice his son. His only son. The son he loved. Abraham was willing. He was willing to give up everything. He was a hero of sacrifice. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For God so loved the world that he gave his one and only Son, that whoever believes in him shall not perish but have eternal life." - John 3:16

Jesus is the greater hero. Abraham was willing to sacrifice his son. God actually sacrificed His Son. Abraham was willing to give up his only son. God gave up His only Son. Abraham was a hero of sacrifice. Jesus is the ultimate hero of sacrifice.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a big heart. Write the name "Jesus" inside it. Talk about how God gave His only Son because He loves us so much.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the sacrifice. Thank you for giving your life for me. Thank you for loving me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big heart with a cross inside and a big smile.

Day 03: The Story of the Hero of the Promise

The Secret Clue (OT)
"I will make you into a great nation, and I will bless you; I will make your name great, and you will be a blessing." - Genesis 12:2

Abraham was a hero. God made a promise to him. God promised him a great nation. God promised him a great name. God promised him a blessing. Abraham waited. He trusted. He believed. He was a hero of the promise. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"This is the genealogy of Jesus the Messiah the son of David, the son of Abraham..." - Matthew 1:1

Jesus is the greater hero. Jesus is the fulfillment of the promise. He is the descendant of Abraham. He is the great nation. He is the great name. He is the blessing. Abraham waited for the promise. Jesus is the promise. Jesus is the ultimate hero of the promise.

Family Activity
Draw a big family tree. Put a star at the top. Write the name "Jesus" next to the star. Talk about how Jesus is part of Abraham's family, and now you are part of His family too.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, God, for keeping your promises. Thank you for Jesus. Thank you for making me part of your family. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big family tree with a shining star at the top.

Day 04: The Story of the Hero of the Test

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Some time later God tested Abraham. He said to him, 'Abraham!' 'Here I am,' he replied." - Genesis 22:1

Abraham was a hero. God tested him. God tried him. God put him through a trial. Abraham passed the test. He passed the trial. He was a hero of the test. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For we do not have a high priest who is unable to empathize with our weaknesses, but we have one who has been tempted in every way, just as we are—yet he did not sin." - Hebrews 4:15

Jesus is the greater hero. Abraham was tested and passed. Jesus was tempted and did not sin. Abraham was tried. Jesus was tried. Abraham was a hero of the test. Jesus is the ultimate hero of the test.

Family Activity
Play a game of "Simon Says." Talk about how Jesus always obeyed. Talk about how He passed every test for us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for passing every test for me. Help me to pass my tests. Help me to trust you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big heart with a checkmark inside it.

Day 05: The Story of the Hero of the Mountain

The Secret Clue (OT)
"On the mountain of the LORD it will be provided." - Genesis 22:14

Abraham was a hero. He went to a mountain. He went to Mount Moriah. He went to the place where God would provide. He called the place "The LORD Will Provide." He was a hero of the mountain. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"And my God will meet all your needs according to the riches of his glory in Christ Jesus." - Philippians 4:19

Jesus is the greater hero. Abraham went to the mountain of provision. Jesus went to the mountain of the cross. Abraham saw God provide a ram. Jesus became the lamb. Abraham was a hero of the mountain. Jesus is the ultimate hero of the mountain.

Family Activity
Build a mountain out of blocks. Put a small toy sheep on top. Talk about how God provided a ram for Abraham, and how Jesus is the lamb for us.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, Jesus, for providing for me. Thank you for being the lamb. Thank you for taking care of me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big mountain with a little lamb and a big smile.

Day 06: The Story of the Hero of the Altar

The Secret Clue (OT)
"So Abram went to live near the great trees of Mamre at Hebron, where he pitched his tents. There he built an altar to the LORD." - Genesis 13:18

Abraham was a hero. He built an altar. He built a place to worship. He built a place to sacrifice. He built a place to meet with God. He was a hero of the altar. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"We have an altar from which those who minister at the tabernacle have no right to eat." - Hebrews 13:10

Jesus is the greater hero. Abraham built an altar. Jesus is the altar. Abraham sacrificed on the altar. Jesus sacrificed himself on the altar. Abraham was a hero of the altar. Jesus is the ultimate hero of the altar.

Family Activity
Build a small altar out of blocks. Put a toy animal on it. Talk about how Jesus is the altar. He is the place where we meet God.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the altar. Thank you for being the place where I can meet God. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big altar with a big heart on it.

Day 07: The Story of the Hero of the Covenant

The Secret Clue (OT)
"On that day the LORD made a covenant with Abram and said, 'To your descendants I give this land...'" - Genesis 15:18

Abraham was a hero. God made a covenant with him. God made an agreement with him. God made a promise with him. He was a hero of the covenant. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For this reason Christ is the mediator of a new covenant, that those who are called may receive the promised eternal inheritance..." - Hebrews 9:15

Jesus is the greater hero. Abraham received a covenant. Jesus is the mediator of the new covenant. Abraham received the promise of land. Jesus received the promise of eternal life. Abraham was a hero of the covenant. Jesus is the ultimate hero of the covenant.

Family Activity
Draw a big scroll. Write the word "Promise" on it. Talk about how Jesus made a new promise with us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for the new covenant. Thank you for the new promise. Help me to live in your promise. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big scroll with a heart and a cross on it.

Day 08: The Story of the Hero of the Stars

The Secret Clue (OT)
"He took him outside and said, 'Look up at the sky and count the stars—if indeed you can count them.' Then he said to him, 'So shall your offspring be.'" - Genesis 15:5

Abraham was a hero. God told him to look at the stars. God told him to count them. God told him his offspring would be like the stars. Abraham believed. He trusted. He was a hero of the stars. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"If you belong to Christ, then you are Abraham's seed, and heirs according to the promise." - Galatians 3:29

Jesus is the greater hero. Abraham's descendants are like the stars. Jesus made it possible for us to be Abraham's descendants. We are the stars. We are the offspring. Abraham was a hero of the stars. Jesus is the ultimate hero of the stars.

Family Activity
Go outside tonight. Look at the stars. Count as many as you can. Talk about how you are a star in God's family.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, God, for the stars. Thank you for making me part of your family. Thank you for Jesus. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A big night sky full of bright stars and a big smile.

Day 09: The Story of the Hero of Faith

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Abram believed the LORD, and he credited it to him as righteousness." - Genesis 15:6

Abraham was a hero. He believed God. He trusted God. He had faith. And God credited it to him as righteousness. He was a hero of faith. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"However, to the one who does not work but trusts God who justifies the ungodly, their faith is credited as righteousness." - Romans 4:5

Jesus is the greater hero. Abraham believed God. We believe in Jesus. Abraham's faith was credited as righteousness. Our faith in Jesus is credited as righteousness. Abraham was a hero of faith. Jesus is the ultimate hero of faith.

Family Activity
Write down this truth: "I am made right with God by faith in Jesus." Say it out loud. Thank Jesus for this gift.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for making me right with God. Thank you for the gift of faith. Help me to believe. Help me to trust. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big heart with a cross inside and a big smile.

Day 10: The Story of the Hero of Obedience

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Early the next morning Abraham got up and loaded his donkey. He took with him two of his servants and his son Isaac." - Genesis 22:3

Abraham was a hero. He obeyed God. He got up early. He loaded his donkey. He took his servants. He took his son. He went. He obeyed. He was a hero of obedience. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"And being found in appearance as a man, he humbled himself by becoming obedient to death—even death on a cross!" - Philippians 2:8

Jesus is the greater hero. Abraham obeyed God. Jesus obeyed the Father. Abraham went to the mountain. Jesus went to the cross. Abraham was a hero of obedience. Jesus is the ultimate hero of obedience.

Family Activity
Play a game of "Follow the Leader." Talk about how Jesus always obeyed. Talk about how He obeyed for us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for obeying for me. Help me to obey you. Help me to follow you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big heart with a checkmark inside it.

Day 11: The Story of the Hero of Trust

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Abraham answered, 'God himself will provide the lamb for the burnt offering, my son.'" - Genesis 22:8

Abraham was a hero. He trusted God. He trusted God to provide. He trusted God to take care of it. He trusted God to provide the lamb. He was a hero of trust. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"The next day John saw Jesus coming toward him and said, 'Look, the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world!'" - John 1:29

Jesus is the greater hero. Abraham trusted God to provide a lamb. God provided Jesus. Abraham trusted in the provision. Jesus is the provision. Abraham was a hero of trust. Jesus is the ultimate hero of trust.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a lamb. Write the name "Jesus" on it. Talk about how Jesus is the lamb God provided for us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the lamb. Thank you for taking away my sin. Thank you for providing for me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A fluffy white lamb with a big smile and a little heart.

Day 12: The Story of the Hero of Provision

The Secret Clue (OT)
"So Abraham called that place The LORD Will Provide. And to this day it is said, 'On the mountain of the LORD it will be provided.'" - Genesis 22:14

Abraham was a hero. He saw God's provision. He saw the ram. He saw the lamb. He called the place "The LORD Will Provide." He was a hero of provision. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"And my God will meet all your needs according to the riches of his glory in Christ Jesus." - Philippians 4:19

Jesus is the greater hero. Abraham saw the provision. Jesus is the provision. Abraham called the place "The LORD Will Provide." Jesus is the Lord who provides. Abraham was a hero of provision. Jesus is the ultimate hero of provision.

Family Activity
Think of a need you have. Write it down. Ask God to provide. Thank Him for being your provider.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for providing for me. Thank you for taking care of me. Help me to trust you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big open hand with a heart in the palm.

Day 13: The Story of the Hero of the Son

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Then God said, 'Take your son, your only son, whom you love—Isaac—and go to the region of Moriah. Sacrifice him there as a burnt offering on a mountain I will show you.'" - Genesis 22:2

Abraham was a hero. God tested him. God tested his son. God tested his child. God tested his family. Abraham passed the test. He was willing to give up his son. He was a hero of the son. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For God so loved the world that he gave his one and only Son, that whoever believes in him shall not perish but have eternal life." - John 3:16

Jesus is the greater hero. Abraham was willing to give up his son. God gave up His Son. Abraham was tested with his son. God gave His Son. Abraham was a hero of the son. Jesus is the ultimate hero of the son.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a father and a son. Write the name "Jesus" above them. Talk about how God gave His Son for us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, God, for giving your Son for me. Thank you, Jesus, for coming to save me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A father and a son holding hands with a big heart above them.

Day 14: The Story of the Hero of the Mountain

The Secret Clue (OT)
"So Abraham called that place The LORD Will Provide. And to this day it is said, 'On the mountain of the LORD it will be provided.'" - Genesis 22:14

Abraham was a hero. He went to the mountain. He went to Moriah. He went to the place where God would provide. He called the place "The LORD Will Provide." He was a hero of the mountain. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For Christ also suffered once for sins, the righteous for the unrighteous, to bring you to God. He was put to death in the body but made alive in the Spirit." - 1 Peter 3:18

Jesus is the greater hero. Abraham went to the mountain. Jesus went to the cross. Abraham went to the place of provision. Jesus became the provision. Abraham was a hero of the mountain. Jesus is the ultimate hero of the mountain.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a mountain. Write the word "Jesus" at the top. Thank Him for going to the mountain of the cross for you.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for going to the cross for me. Thank you for providing for me. Help me to trust you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big mountain with a cross at the top and a big smile.

Day 15: The Story of the Hero of the Altar

The Secret Clue (OT)
"So Abram went to live near the great trees of Mamre at Hebron, where he pitched his tents. There he built an altar to the LORD." - Genesis 13:18

Abraham was a hero. He built an altar. He built a place of worship. He built a place of sacrifice. He built a place to meet with God. He was a hero of the altar. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"We have an altar from which those who minister at the tabernacle have no right to eat." - Hebrews 13:10

Jesus is the greater hero. Abraham built an altar. Jesus is the altar. Abraham sacrificed on the altar. Jesus sacrificed himself on the altar. Abraham was a hero of the altar. Jesus is the ultimate hero of the altar.

Family Activity
Find a quiet place to meet with God. It could be your room. It could be a park. Spend five minutes there with God. Thank Jesus for being the altar.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the altar. Thank you for being the place where I can meet God. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big altar with a big heart on it.

Day 16: The Story of the Hero of the Covenant

The Secret Clue (OT)
"On that day the LORD made a covenant with Abram and said, 'To your descendants I give this land...'" - Genesis 15:18

Abraham was a hero. God made a covenant with him. God made an agreement with him. God made a promise with him. He was a hero of the covenant. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For this reason Christ is the mediator of a new covenant, that those who are called may receive the promised eternal inheritance..." - Hebrews 9:15

Jesus is the greater hero. Abraham received a covenant. Jesus is the mediator of the new covenant. Abraham received the promise of land. Jesus received the promise of eternal life. Abraham was a hero of the covenant. Jesus is the ultimate hero of the covenant.

Family Activity
Write down one promise from the new covenant. For example, "My sins are forgiven." Say it out loud. Thank Jesus for making a new covenant with you.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for the new covenant. Thank you for the new promise. Help me to live in your promise. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big scroll with a heart and a cross on it.

Day 17: The Story of the Hero of the Stars

The Secret Clue (OT)
"He took him outside and said, 'Look up at the sky and count the stars—if indeed you can count them.' Then he said to him, 'So shall your offspring be.'" - Genesis 15:5

Abraham was a hero. God told him to look at the stars. God told him to count them. God told him his offspring would be like the stars. Abraham believed. He trusted. He was a hero of the stars. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"If you belong to Christ, then you are Abraham's seed, and heirs according to the promise." - Galatians 3:29

Jesus is the greater hero. Abraham's descendants are like the stars. Jesus made it possible for us to be Abraham's descendants. We are the stars. We are the offspring. Abraham was a hero of the stars. Jesus is the ultimate hero of the stars.

Family Activity
Go outside tonight. Look at the stars. Count as many as you can. Talk about how you are a star in God's family.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, God, for the stars. Thank you for making me part of your family. Thank you for Jesus. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big night sky full of bright stars and a big smile.

Day 18: The Story of the Hero of Faith

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Abram believed the LORD, and he credited it to him as righteousness." - Genesis 15:6

Abraham was a hero. He believed God. He trusted God. He had faith. And God credited it to him as righteousness. He was a hero of faith. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"However, to the one who does not work but trusts God who justifies the ungodly, their faith is credited as righteousness." - Romans 4:5

Jesus is the greater hero. Abraham believed God. We believe in Jesus. Abraham's faith was credited as righteousness. Our faith in Jesus is credited as righteousness. Abraham was a hero of faith. Jesus is the ultimate hero of faith.

Family Activity
Write down this truth: "I am made right with God by faith in Jesus." Say it out loud. Thank Jesus for this gift.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for making me right with God. Thank you for the gift of faith. Help me to believe. Help me to trust. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big heart with a cross inside and a big smile.

Day 19: The Story of the Hero of Obedience

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Early the next morning Abraham got up and loaded his donkey. He took with him two of his servants and his son Isaac." - Genesis 22:3

Abraham was a hero. He obeyed God. He got up early. He loaded his donkey. He took his servants. He took his son. He went. He obeyed. He was a hero of obedience. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"And being found in appearance as a man, he humbled himself by becoming obedient to death—even death on a cross!" - Philippians 2:8

Jesus is the greater hero. Abraham obeyed God. Jesus obeyed the Father. Abraham went to the mountain. Jesus went to the cross. Abraham was a hero of obedience. Jesus is the ultimate hero of obedience.

Family Activity
Play a game of "Follow the Leader." Talk about how Jesus always obeyed. Talk about how He obeyed for us.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, Jesus, for obeying for me. Help me to obey you. Help me to follow you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big heart with a checkmark inside it.

Day 20: The Story of the Hero of Trust

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Abraham answered, 'God himself will provide the lamb for the burnt offering, my son.'" - Genesis 22:8

Abraham was a hero. He trusted God. He trusted God to provide. He trusted God to take care of it. He trusted God to provide the lamb. He was a hero of trust. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"The next day John saw Jesus coming toward him and said, 'Look, the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world!'" - John 1:29

Jesus is the greater hero. Abraham trusted God to provide a lamb. God provided Jesus. Abraham trusted in the provision. Jesus is the provision. Abraham was a hero of trust. Jesus is the ultimate hero of trust.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a lamb. Write the name "Jesus" on it. Talk about how Jesus is the lamb God provided for us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the lamb. Thank you for taking away my sin. Thank you for providing for me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A fluffy white lamb with a big smile and a little heart.

Day 21: The Story of the Hero of Provision

The Secret Clue (OT)
"So Abraham called that place The LORD Will Provide. And to this day it is said, 'On the mountain of the LORD it will be provided.'" - Genesis 22:14

Abraham was a hero. He saw God's provision. He saw the ram. He saw the lamb. He called the place "The LORD Will Provide." He was a hero of provision. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"And my God will meet all your needs according to the riches of his glory in Christ Jesus." - Philippians 4:19

Jesus is the greater hero. Abraham saw the provision. Jesus is the provision. Abraham called the place "The LORD Will Provide." Jesus is the Lord who provides. Abraham was a hero of provision. Jesus is the ultimate hero of provision.

Family Activity
Think of a need you have. Write it down. Ask God to provide. Thank Him for being your provider.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for providing for me. Thank you for taking care of me. Help me to trust you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big open hand with a heart in the palm.

Day 22: The Story of the Hero of the Son

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Then God said, 'Take your son, your only son, whom you love—Isaac—and go to the region of Moriah. Sacrifice him there as a burnt offering on a mountain I will show you.'" - Genesis 22:2

Abraham was a hero. God tested him. God tested his son. God tested his child. God tested his family. Abraham passed the test. He was willing to give up his son. He was a hero of the son. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For God so loved the world that he gave his one and only Son, that whoever believes in him shall not perish but have eternal life." - John 3:16

Jesus is the greater hero. Abraham was willing to give up his son. God gave up His Son. Abraham was tested with his son. God gave His Son. Abraham was a hero of the son. Jesus is the ultimate hero of the son.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a father and a son. Write the name "Jesus" above them. Talk about how God gave His Son for us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, God, for giving your Son for me. Thank you, Jesus, for coming to save me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A father and a son holding hands with a big heart above them.

Day 23: The Story of the Hero of the Mountain

The Secret Clue (OT)
"So Abraham called that place The LORD Will Provide. And to this day it is said, 'On the mountain of the LORD it will be provided.'" - Genesis 22:14

Abraham was a hero. He went to the mountain. He went to Moriah. He went to the place where God would provide. He called the place "The LORD Will Provide." He was a hero of the mountain. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For Christ also suffered once for sins, the righteous for the unrighteous, to bring you to God. He was put to death in the body but made alive in the Spirit." - 1 Peter 3:18

Jesus is the greater hero. Abraham went to the mountain. Jesus went to the cross. Abraham went to the place of provision. Jesus became the provision. Abraham was a hero of the mountain. Jesus is the ultimate hero of the mountain.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a mountain. Write the word "Jesus" at the top. Thank Him for going to the mountain of the cross for you.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for going to the cross for me. Thank you for providing for me. Help me to trust you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big mountain with a cross at the top and a big smile.

Day 24: The Story of the Hero of the Altar

The Secret Clue (OT)
"So Abram went to live near the great trees of Mamre at Hebron, where he pitched his tents. There he built an altar to the LORD." - Genesis 13:18

Abraham was a hero. He built an altar. He built a place of worship. He built a place of sacrifice. He built a place to meet with God. He was a hero of the altar. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)

"We have an altar from which those who minister at the tabernacle have no right to eat." - Hebrews 13:10

Jesus is the greater hero. Abraham built an altar. Jesus is the altar. Abraham sacrificed on the altar. Jesus sacrificed himself on the altar. Abraham was a hero of the altar. Jesus is the ultimate hero of the altar.

Family Activity
Find a quiet place to meet with God. Spend five minutes there with Him. Thank Jesus for being the altar.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the altar. Thank you for being the place where I can meet God. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big altar with a big heart on it.

Day 25: The Story of the Hero of the Covenant

The Secret Clue (OT)
"On that day the LORD made a covenant with Abram and said, 'To your descendants I give this land...'" - Genesis 15:18

Abraham was a hero. God made a covenant with him. God made an agreement with him. God made a promise with him. He was a hero of the covenant. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For this reason Christ is the mediator of a new covenant, that those who are called may receive the promised eternal inheritance..." - Hebrews 9:15

Jesus is the greater hero. Abraham received a covenant. Jesus is the mediator of the new covenant. Abraham received the promise of land. Jesus received the promise of eternal life. Abraham was a hero of the covenant. Jesus is the ultimate hero of the covenant.

Family Activity
Write down one promise from the new covenant. Say it out loud. Thank Jesus for making a new covenant with you.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for the new covenant. Thank you for the new promise. Help me to live in your promise. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big scroll with a heart and a cross on it.

Day 26: The Story of the Hero of the Stars

The Secret Clue (OT)
"He took him outside and said, 'Look up at the sky and count the stars—if indeed you can count them.' Then he said to him, 'So shall your offspring be.'" - Genesis 15:5

Abraham was a hero. God told him to look at the stars. God told him to count them. God told him his offspring would be like the stars. Abraham believed. He trusted. He was a hero of the stars. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"If you belong to Christ, then you are Abraham's seed, and heirs according to the promise." - Galatians 3:29

Jesus is the greater hero. Abraham's descendants are like the stars. Jesus made it possible for us to be Abraham's descendants. We are the stars. We are the offspring. Abraham was a hero of the stars. Jesus is the ultimate hero of the stars.

Family Activity
Go outside tonight. Look at the stars. Count as many as you can. Talk about how you are a star in God's family.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, God, for the stars. Thank you for making me part of your family. Thank you for Jesus. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big night sky full of bright stars and a big smile.

Day 27: The Story of the Hero of Faith Again

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Abram believed the LORD, and he credited it to him as righteousness." - Genesis 15:6

Abraham was a hero. He believed God. He trusted God. He had faith. And God credited it to him as righteousness. He was a hero of faith.

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Day 27: The Story of the Hero of Faith Again (Continued)

The Big Reveal (NT)
"However, to the one who does not work but trusts God who justifies the ungodly, their faith is credited as righteousness." - Romans 4:5

Jesus is the greater hero. Abraham believed God. We believe in Jesus. Abraham's faith was credited as righteousness. Our faith in Jesus is credited as righteousness. Abraham was a hero of faith. Jesus is the ultimate hero of faith.

Family Activity
Write down this truth: "I am made right with God by faith in Jesus." Say it out loud. Thank Jesus for this gift.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for making me right with God. Thank you for the gift of faith. Help me to believe. Help me to trust. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big heart with a cross inside and a big smile.

Day 28: The Story of the Hero of Obedience Again

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Early the next morning Abraham got up and loaded his donkey. He took with him two of his servants and his son Isaac." - Genesis 22:3

Abraham was a hero. He obeyed God. He got up early. He loaded his donkey. He took his servants. He took his son. He went. He obeyed. He was a hero of obedience. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"And being found in appearance as a man, he humbled himself by becoming obedient to death—even death on a cross!" - Philippians 2:8

Jesus is the greater hero. Abraham obeyed God. Jesus obeyed the Father. Abraham went to the mountain. Jesus went to the cross. Abraham was a hero of obedience. Jesus is the ultimate hero of obedience.

Family Activity
Play a game of "Follow the Leader." Talk about how Jesus always obeyed. Talk about how He obeyed for us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for obeying for me. Help me to obey you. Help me to follow you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big heart with a checkmark inside it.

Day 29: The Story of the Hero of Trust Again

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Abraham answered, 'God himself will provide the lamb for the burnt offering, my son.'" - Genesis 22:8

Abraham was a hero. He trusted God. He trusted God to provide. He trusted God to take care of it. He trusted God to provide the lamb. He was a hero of trust. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"The next day John saw Jesus coming toward him and said, 'Look, the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world!'" - John 1:29

Jesus is the greater hero. Abraham trusted God to provide a lamb. God provided Jesus. Abraham trusted in the provision. Jesus is the provision. Abraham was a hero of trust. Jesus is the ultimate hero of trust.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a lamb. Write the name "Jesus" on it. Talk about how Jesus is the lamb God provided for us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the lamb. Thank you for taking away my sin. Thank you for providing for me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A fluffy white lamb with a big smile and a little heart.

Day 30: The Story of the Ultimate Hero

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Abram believed the LORD, and he credited it to him as righteousness." - Genesis 15:6

Abraham was a hero. He was a hero of faith. He was a hero of sacrifice. He was a hero of the promise. He was a hero of the test. He was a hero of the mountain. He was a hero of the altar. He was a hero of the covenant. He was a hero of the stars. He was a hero of provision. He was a hero of trust. He was a hero of obedience. He was a hero of the son. But he was not the ultimate hero. He was a clue. He was a shadow. He was a preview. He pointed to the ultimate hero. That hero is Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For the Son of Man came to seek and to save the lost." - Luke 19:10

Jesus is the ultimate hero. He is the one who came to seek. He is the one who came to save. He is the one who came to rescue. He is the fulfillment of Abraham. He is the ultimate hero.

Family Activity
Write down one thing you have learned about the ultimate hero over the last 30 days. Thank God for the ultimate hero. Thank Him for Jesus.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, God, for Abraham. Thank you for the heroes of the faith. Thank you for Jesus. Thank you for the ultimate hero. Help me to trust the hero. Help me to follow the hero. Help me to live in the rescue of the hero. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big crown with a big heart in the middle and a shining star above.

END MATTER

The "Story Detective" Certificate

This certifies that [Child's Name] has completed the More Than Just a Story adventure. You followed 30 secret clues and discovered the greatest treasure: Jesus. You are officially a Story Detective.

Date: _____

Signed by (Parent or Teacher): _____

Family Discussion Cards

Card 1: What was your favorite story from this book?
Card 2: What was the coolest hero you learned about?
Card 3: Why do you think God gave us so many heroes who point to Jesus?
Card 4: How does it feel to know Jesus is the ultimate hero?
Card 5: Who is someone you can tell about Jesus?
Card 6: What is your favorite prayer from this book?
Card 7: If you could ask Jesus one question, what would it be?
Card 8: What is one way you can show Jesus' love to someone today?
Card 9: What is your favorite coloring page from this book?
Card 10: What is one thing you want to remember about Jesus forever?

A Note for the Parent: Building on the Foundation

You did it. You spent 30 days reading stories with your children. But the adventure does not end here. It is just beginning.

Here are a few tips to keep going:

1. Make it a habit, not a chore. Do not stress about reading the Bible for 30 minutes a day. A simple 5 minute rhythm before bed is better than an hour once a month.
2. Let them see you reading. Kids do what they see. Let them catch you reading your Bible. Let them see that it matters to you.
3. Ask "Where is Jesus?" in every story. Whenever you read a Bible story, ask your child, "Where do you see Jesus in this story?" This trains them to look for Jesus everywhere.
4. Recommended next steps. Read The Jesus Storybook Bible by Sally Lloyd-Jones. Read The Biggest Story by Kevin DeYoung. Keep pointing them to the Treasure.

You are doing a great job. Keep going.

Sneak Peek: The Secret Hero

If you loved this adventure, there is another one waiting for you. The Secret Hero takes you on a journey through how Joseph, David, and Jonah point to Jesus. It is full of activities, coloring pages, and simple prayers.

Final Call to Action

Scan the QR code below to get the next book in the series. Visit our website to download a free reading plan. Join our community of families. The adventure is not over. The journey is just beginning.

Cover Design Concept (The Children's Edition)

A bright yellow or sky blue background. A cartoon child detective with a magnifying glass. The child is looking at a big, glowing storybook with pictures of Old Testament heroes on it. A small, friendly cartoon lamb is sitting next to the child. The title MORE THAN JUST A STORY is in a chunky, bouncy, playful font. The word STORY is in bright red with a book replacing the letter O. The overall feel is fun, exciting, and irresistible to a child.